

THE SCALE IS NOT THE SCORE.

What the number can tell you — and what it quietly distorts.

The scale is a tool. It is not a verdict on your character, your week, or whether the plan is working. Daily weight is noisy. Water, glycogen, gut content, hormones, and salt all move the number without changing fat mass. When the scale becomes the only scoreboard, panic and false celebration both arrive on schedule.

WHAT THE SCALE MEASURES

Total mass. That includes fat, muscle, water, food in the gut, and glycogen stored in muscle and liver.

A hard training session, a salty meal, a menstrual cycle phase, or a few days of higher carbohydrate intake can all raise the number while body fat is stable or falling.

The scale is honest about mass. It is silent about composition.

BETTER SIGNALS

Trend, not single days. If you weigh, use a weekly average.

How clothes fit. Slow and useful.

Training performance. Strength and work capacity holding or rising.

Energy and recovery. Flatness is information.

Occasional photos or a simple tape under the same conditions.

Together these tell a clearer story than any single morning on the scale.

× COMMON FOLLY — SCALE TRAPS

- × **Daily weigh-ins as emotional weather.** The number jumps. Mood follows. Decisions get made from noise. Weigh less often, or average the week, and keep the emotional volume down.
- × **Celebrating or panicking on one reading.** A 0.7 kg drop after a low-carb day is often water. A 0.7 kg rise after a normal meal is often the same. Neither is a story about your discipline.
- × **Ignoring everything else when the scale stalls.** Clothes looser, training stronger, energy better — and the scale flat — is still progress. Composition can improve while total mass holds.

IF YOU USE THE SCALE

Same conditions: morning, after the bathroom, before food, light clothing. Record it. Do not negotiate with it.

Look at the weekly average. Look at the direction over three to four weeks. That is the signal.

If the number controls your mood more than it informs your decisions, put it away for a month and use the other signals instead.

WHAT PROGRESS ACTUALLY IS

For fat loss: a downward trend in mass or girth over weeks, while strength and energy are protected.

For muscle: performance up, measurements or photos improving, scale stable or slowly rising.

The score is the trend across time, not the digit you see before breakfast.

Next step: Pick two non-scale signals and track them for four weeks alongside any weigh-ins. Let the trend speak. Free programme at beinghaware.github.io/BHAFL.